Aleksandr Simonov

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Limassol, Cyprus
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Senior Platform / DevOps Engineer

Senior Platform / DevOps Engineer with **12+ years in IT**, including **7+ years** designing, building, and scaling cloud-native infrastructure across AWS, GCP, and on-premises environments. Deep experience with Kubernetes platforms including EKS, Rancher, OpenShift, and bare-metal deployments. Focused on resilient, secure, highly automated platforms that improve operational reliability and engineering delivery.

Technical Skills

Container Platforms:	Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, Rancher, OpenShift/OKD, Helm, Helmfile
Infrastructure / IaC:	Terraform, Terragrunt, Pulumi, Ansible, Puppet, Foreman
Delivery / GitOps:	GitLab CI/CD, Argo CD, Bamboo, reusable deployment pipelines
Cloud / Data:	AWS, GCP, Redis, Kafka, Amazon RDS, MSK, SQS, SNS, BigQuery
Observability:	Prometheus, VictoriaMetrics, Loki, OpenSearch
Engineering:	Linux, Go, Python, platform security, high availability, incident response

Experience

Platform Engineer Jul 2024 – Present

Exness *Limassol, Cyprus*

Technologies: Linux, Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, Rancher, GitLab CI/CD, Terraform, Terragrunt, Helm, Helmfile, Argo CD, Redis, Go

- Manage and optimise **hundreds of Kubernetes clusters** across bare-metal, Amazon EKS, and Rancher environments, improving stability, performance, and reliability.
- Design resilient Redis deployments using standalone, primary-replica, and Sentinel-based topologies.
- Automate cluster provisioning and lifecycle operations through GitLab CI/CD, reducing manual effort and accelerating infrastructure delivery.
- Build reusable tooling with Terraform, Terragrunt, Helm, Helmfile, and Go to improve consistency across diverse environments.
- Drive GitOps adoption with Argo CD and partner with SRE and development teams on complex production issues and platform health.

DevOps Engineer Dec 2023 – Jul 2024

Inktech *Cyprus*

Technologies: Kubernetes, GCP, GitLab CI/CD, Pulumi, Helm, Python, BigQuery, Airflow, ClickHouse, Kafka, VictoriaMetrics, Loki, Prometheus

- Designed and optimised GitLab CI/CD pipelines, integrating Pulumi to streamline infrastructure and application deployments.
- Automated GCP infrastructure with Pulumi and Helm; collaborated on scalable data solutions using BigQuery, Airflow, ClickHouse, and Kafka.
- Implemented an observability stack based on VictoriaMetrics, Loki, and Prometheus.

DevOps Engineer Jun 2023 – Dec 2023

Oxygen *Cyprus*

Technologies: Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, AWS, GitLab CI/CD, Terraform, Helm, Python, Airflow, Prometheus, OpenSearch, KMS, Secrets Manager

- Led a DevOps team responsible for cloud infrastructure supporting the Oxygen Bank financial platform.
- Led the migration to Amazon EKS and integrated managed Prometheus and OpenSearch services.
- Automated infrastructure with Terraform and Helm and strengthened security with AWS KMS and Secrets Manager.

Senior DevOps Engineer Nov 2021 – Jun 2023

UpGate *Limassol, Cyprus*

Technologies: Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, OpenShift/OKD, GitLab CI/CD, AWS, Terraform, Helm, RDS, MSK, Airflow, Camunda, Kafka

- Built **PCI DSS-compliant** AWS infrastructure from the ground up, including Amazon EKS, RDS, and MSK.
- Designed OpenShift environments and automated infrastructure and CI/CD workflows with Terraform and GitLab CI/CD.
- Supported Java and Python services in close partnership with development teams.

Senior DevOps Engineer Mar 2021 – Nov 2021
Align Technology *Moscow, Russia*
Technologies: Linux, AWS, Amazon EKS, Terraform, Helm, Bamboo, Java, Amazon SQS, Amazon SNS

- Embedded in a team building a **HIPAA-compliant** medical service using machine learning to segment CBCT scans.
- Automated EKS with Terraform and Helm, and built Bamboo pipelines supporting an SQS/SNS event-driven architecture.

Cloud Automation Engineer (DevOps) Feb 2019 – Oct 2020
RingCentral *Saint Petersburg, Russia*
Technologies: Linux, GitLab CI/CD, AWS, GCP, VMware, Ansible, Puppet, Foreman, Go

- Automated AWS AMI and GCP instance-template creation for PCI DSS-compliant environments.
- Developed server provisioning and configuration pipelines using Puppet, Foreman, and Ansible.
- Partnered with security teams to meet infrastructure security and compliance requirements.

Network Administrator Feb 2017 – Feb 2019
Saber Interactive *Saint Petersburg, Russia*
Technologies: Linux, VMware vSphere, ProFTPD, hardware access-control systems

- Administered Linux servers and an on-premises data centre; automated administrative tasks and built VMware statistics, IT inventory, access-control, and ProFTPD tools.

System Administrator Apr 2015 – Feb 2017
NBcom Group *Saint Petersburg, Russia*

- Administered Windows Server, Active Directory, pfSense, and MikroTik infrastructure while supporting retail locations.

Technical Support Specialist Feb 2014 – Mar 2015
Helix Laboratory Service *Saint Petersburg, Russia*

- Administered Windows Server, Active Directory, pfSense, and MikroTik systems and supported laboratory locations.

SCADA Engineer Dec 2012 – Jan 2014
Severnaya / Northern Kuzbass (ArcelorMittal) *Berezovskiy, Russia*

- Maintained coal-plant automation equipment, configured Wonderware InTouch SCADA, and programmed Toshiba, OWEN, and Siemens controllers.

Education

Kemerovo Vocational and Technical College 2007 – 2009
Associate Degree, Computer Science

Certifications & Languages

CKA: Certified Kubernetes Administrator
CKAD: Certified Kubernetes Application Developer
GitOps Fundamentals

Russian – Native or Bilingual
English – Full Professional
EF SET English Certificate 66/100 (C1 Advanced)